

Once you've nailed down the Clip Art, you can insert it onto the selected slide by double-clicking the thumbnail view. Alternatively, select the downward-pointing arrow located at the left of the thumbnail on each Clip Art and click Insert from the drop-down menu.

You will also find several other options in this drop-down, where you can copy the Clip Art from one collection to another, edit its keywords, and find Clip Art of a similar nature.

14.2 Editing Clip Art

A cool thing is, you can browse and download thousands of Clip Art items in various categories (such as abstract, cartoons, communications, and many more) from <http://office.microsoft.com/en-us/clipart/default.aspx?lc=en-us>. You can also edit the ones you already have! To increase the usefulness of the Clip Art you have, you can flip, rotate, distort, crop, convert, and combine multiple pieces of Clip Art to create new pictures. But before you embark on such editing, you need to understand that some Clip Art formats are suitable for modification and some aren't.

Most of the Clip Art items in PowerPoint are bitmap images. These are made up of dots arranged in patterns, and it's not a good format for editing where it involves resizing, rotating, and stretching. Images of this format can be used for editing that involves cropping, colourising, and converting to B&W. Common bitmap formats are PCX, GIF, BMP, JPEG, PNG, and TIFF. On the other hand, graphics programs like CAD software and programs like Corel Draw and Illustrator produce vector graphic images. These consist of a series of mathematical statements that specify lines. The advantage here is that they can be rescaled without losing on image quality. The drawings you create in Word using the drawing toolbar are created as vector graphics. Vector graphics images usually have .WMF and .EMF as file extensions.